“If I'm not healed, I must not be right with God.”

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Where it often comes from

Some equate health with God’s favor and illness with distance from Him. Without healing, we may scour our lives for hidden sin or doubt our salvation.

What Scripture teaches

“Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus” (Romans 8:1). Right standing with God comes by grace through faith in Christ, not by health. Paul, Timothy, Epaphroditus, and Trophimus were all faithful and all sick at times. “Neither this man nor his parents sinned,” said Jesus of the blind man. Paul’s promise that nothing “will be able to separate us from the love of God that is in Christ Jesus our Lord” includes illness. Health is a blessing, but it is not the proof of God’s favor.

> *“Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus”* (Romans 8:1).

Also see

> “For I am convinced that neither death nor life, neither angels nor principalities, neither the present nor the future, nor any powers, neither height nor depth, nor anything else in all creation, will be able to separate us from the love of God that is in Christ Jesus our Lord” (Romans 8:38–39).

> “Jesus answered, ‘Neither this man nor his parents sinned, but this happened so that the works of God would be displayed in him.’” (John 9:3).

> “Erastus has remained at Corinth, and Trophimus I left sick in Miletus” (2 Timothy 4:20).

> “For it is by grace you have been saved through faith, and this not from yourselves; it is the gift of God, not by works, so that no one can boast” (Ephesians 2:8–9).

Common self-statements

- Healthy people are in good standing with God.
- I am being passed over.
- I am out of favor.
- Something is blocking me.
- I should be healed if I were right.
- I am under a cloud.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing health shows favor and illness shows disfavor.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that God is displeased.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling sick and concluding that I am not right with God.
- Labeling: Calling myself out of favor.

Challenging questions

- What do I think healing would prove about me?

- What does Scripture say about right standing with God?
- Which faithful people in Scripture were ill?
- What is true of me in Christ?
- What would it mean to rest in grace?
- Who can remind me of God's love?

Truth summary

> My standing with God is secured by Christ, not by my health. Illness does not mean God is displeased. Nothing can separate me from His love.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Grace
- Sickness
- Guilt/Shame
- Suffering
- God, All Loving

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Love
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "If I'm not healed, I must not be right with God"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"If I'm not healed, I must not be right with God." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do I think healing would prove about me?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about right standing with God?
- ☐ Which faithful people in Scripture were ill?
- ☐ What is true of me in Christ?
- ☐ What would it mean to rest in grace?
- ☐ Who can remind me of God's love?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ There is no condemnation in Christ.
- ☐ Nothing separates me from His love.
- ☐ Faithful people were sick, too.
- ☐ Grace is a gift.
- ☐ Health is not my standing.
- ☐ I rest in Christ.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Romans 8:1**
  "Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus."
- ☐ **Romans 8:38–39**
  "For I am convinced that neither death nor life, neither angels nor principalities, neither the present nor the future, nor any powers, neither height nor depth, nor anything else in all creation, will be able to separate us from the love of God that is in Christ Jesus our Lord."
- ☐ **John 9:3**
  "Jesus answered, 'Neither this man nor his parents sinned, but this happened so that the works of God would be displayed in him.'"

A verse I found myself: _____

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Secure in Christ: Each week, note one reminder of grace.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Romans 8:1 becomes: "Sarah can write: "There is no condemnation for me in Christ.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Grace" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Read Romans 8. Underline the promises.
- [ ] Name the fear. Write what you fear is blocking you.
- [ ] Confess if there is sin. Receive forgiveness.
- [ ] Share. Talk to a pastor or counselor.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "If I'm not healed, I must not be right with God": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Secure in Christ
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~If I'm not healed, I must not be right with God.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, I fear I am out of favor. Thank You that in Christ there is no condemnation and nothing can separate me from Your love. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.